VEKTRUS

Brand Guidelines

The complete guide to our visual identity and brand system

Version 2.0 • February 2026

Confidential

Contents

01. Strategy Foundation 3
02. Mission, Vision & Values 4
03. Brand Personality 5
04. Logo System 6
05. Logo Variations & Usage 7
06. Clear Space & Minimum Size 8
07. Color Hierarchy 9
08. Color Usage Rules 10
09. Typography System 11
10. Typography Hierarchy 12
11. UI Components 13
12. AI State Logic & Animations 14
13. Imagery & Illustration 15
14. Iconography 16
15. Social Media Design Rules 17
16. Presentation Templates 18
17. Stationery & Email 19
18. Do’s and Don’ts 20
19. Application Examples 21
20. Asset Library & File Structure 22

01. Strategy Foundation

This brand guidelines document defines the visual and verbal identity system for Vektrus. It ensures consistency across all touchpoints—from product interfaces to marketing materials, from social media to sales presentations.

Who This Is For

- Product and engineering teams building Vektrus interfaces
- Marketing and content teams creating external communications
- Design partners and freelancers producing brand assets
- Sales teams creating pitch decks and customer-facing materials

Brand Positioning

> *Vektrus combines personalized AI, real-time trend updates, and integrated analytics into one intuitive platform—offering agency-level strategy at a fixed, affordable monthly price without complexity or long-term contracts.*

Tagline

Social Media. Automatisiert. Für dich.

02. Mission, Vision & Values

Mission

Democratize high-quality social media growth by providing every business—regardless of size—with an intelligent, personalized AI system that automates strategy, saves time, and delivers measurable impact.

Vision

Become the leading AI system for social media strategy and automation in Europe, setting the standard for intelligent, accessible, and continuously learning digital growth systems.

Core Values

Value	Description
Accessibility & Fairness	Every business deserves intelligent social media strategy, regardless of budget or team size.
Innovation & Learning	Our AI continuously evolves—learning from data, adapting to platform changes, growing smarter.
Simplicity & Usability	Powerful technology should feel effortless. Every feature is designed for clarity and speed.
Transparency & Data Protection	German data storage, encrypted connections, clear communication. Trust is non-negotiable.
Performance & Impact	Every recommendation ties to measurable outcomes. Real growth, not vanity metrics.

03. Brand Personality

Archetypes

Primary — The Creator: Innovation, intelligent systems, building better solutions. Vektrus creates tailored strategies and builds systems that evolve.

Secondary — The Guide: Supportive, clear, empowering. Vektrus mentors users through their social media journey with confidence-building insights.

Human Traits

Smart, calm, reliable, structured, motivating, modern, approachable.

Voice & Tone

Dimension	Position	Ratio	Application
Funny ↔ Serious	Mostly serious	30/70	Subtle lightness, never childish
Casual ↔ Formal	Lean casual	60/40	Du-Ansprache, approachable
Irreverent ↔ Respectful	Mostly respectful	20/80	Bold but grounded
Enthusiastic ↔ Fact-based	Balanced	50/50	Inspire with evidence

Language Conventions

- Du-Ansprache (informal “you”) in all customer-facing communication
- German primary; English for international audiences
- Technical terms explained in plain language on first use
- Data-backed claims wherever possible

04. Logo System

The Vektrus logo system consists of three components designed for different use cases. The V symbol represents direction, growth, and AI connectivity through its abstract vector triangle with network nodes.

Logo Components

A. Combination Mark (Primary)

The primary logo pairs the V symbol with the Vektrus wordmark. Use this as the default across all marketing materials, website headers, and presentation title slides. The symbol sits left-aligned with the wordmark.

B. Wordmark Only

The standalone Vektrus wordmark in Manrope Bold. Use when the symbol is too small to be legible (e.g., narrow navigation bars, text-heavy layouts). The wordmark carries brand recognition through its distinctive typography.

C. Symbol Only

The V symbol with network nodes. Use as an app icon, favicon, social media avatar, or whenever a compact square mark is needed. The network node structure within the V represents AI and data connectivity.

Strategic Rationale

- The V shape represents both the brand name and directional growth (vector)
- Network nodes symbolize AI intelligence, data connections, and continuous learning
- The gradient from Light Blue to Vektrus Blue creates visual depth and modern appeal
- Rounded stroke endings convey approachability and soften the technical geometry

05. Logo Variations & Usage

Color Variations

Variation	Usage & Specifications
Primary (Full Color)	Vektrus Blue #49B7E3 + Light Blue #B6EBF7 gradient. Default for all standard applications on light backgrounds.
Secondary (Flat)	Flat Vektrus Blue single-tone version. Use when gradient reproduction is limited (e.g., single-color print, embroidery).
Monochrome Black	Full black (#111111) version. Use on formal documents, legal materials, or when color is unavailable.
Reversed White	White logo on Vektrus Blue or dark backgrounds. Use in headers, hero sections, and dark UI contexts.

Correct Applications

1. Website header on light (#F4FCFE or white) background
2. Dashboard navigation bar with combination mark
3. App icon and favicon using symbol only
4. Social media profile avatar using symbol only
5. Presentation title slide on gradient background using reversed white

Incorrect Applications

1. ✘ Do not apply gradients inside the typography of the wordmark
2. ✘ Do not use AI Violet as the primary brand color for the logo
3. ✘ Do not distort proportions or stretch the logo
4. ✘ Do not apply drop shadows on the logo
5. ✘ Do not place on dark/neon backgrounds that reduce contrast

06. Clear Space & Minimum Size

Clear Space Requirements

The minimum clear space around the Vektrus logo is defined by the height of the “V” in the symbol mark. This ensures the logo maintains visual integrity and is never crowded by surrounding elements.

- Clear space unit = Height of the V symbol
- Minimum 1x unit of clear space on all four sides
- For the wordmark alone, clear space = Cap height of the “V” letter
- No other logos, text, or graphic elements may enter the clear space zone

Minimum Size Specifications

Context	Minimum Width	Notes
Digital (combination)	120px	Below this, use wordmark or symbol only
Digital (symbol only)	24px	Favicon-safe at this size
Print (combination)	40mm	For business cards, use back of card for full mark
Print (symbol only)	15mm	Minimum for legible network node detail

07. Color Hierarchy

The Vektrus color system is structured in four tiers: primary, secondary, neutral, and accent. Each color has a defined role and psychological rationale.

Primary Colors

Color	Hex	Values	Psychology
Light Blue	#B6EBF7	Pantone 2905 C RGB 182,235,247 CMYK 26,0,4,3	Clarity, openness, calm invitation
Vektrus Blue	#49B7E3	Pantone 299 C RGB 73,183,227 CMYK 68,19,0,11	Trust, structure, reliability

Secondary Colors

Color	Hex	Role	Psychology
AI Violet	#7C6CF2	AI features, innovation accents	Intelligence & creativity
Mint White	#F4FCFE	Page backgrounds, card fills	Calmness & usability
Soft Gray	#7A7A7A	Secondary text, borders	Neutrality & balance

Accent Colors

Color	Hex	Application
Success Green	#49D69E	Confirmation states, growth metrics, positive feedback, completed actions
Alert Red	#FA7E70	Error states, destructive actions, critical warnings, validation errors
Waiting Orange	#F4BE9D	Loading states, pending actions, in-progress indicators, attention-needed alerts

08. Color Usage Rules

Hierarchy & Ratios

- Primary backgrounds: Mint White (#F4FCFE) or White (#FFFFFF) — used for 70–80% of any layout
- Vektrus Blue: Primary action color, links, headers, CTAs — used for 15–20%
- Light Blue: Supporting backgrounds, cards, hover states — used sparingly
- AI Violet: Reserved exclusively for AI-related features — maximum 10% of any composition
- Accent colors: Only for status indicators and data visualization — never as decorative elements

Contrast & Accessibility

- All text must meet WCAG 2.1 AA contrast ratios (4.5:1 for body text, 3:1 for large text)
- Anthrazit (#111111) on White: 18.4:1 ratio — exceeds AAA
- Vektrus Blue (#49B7E3) on White: 3.2:1 ratio — use only for large text (18px+) or non-text elements
- Never place Light Blue text on white backgrounds
- For body text, always use Anthrazit (#111111) or Soft Gray (#7A7A7A) on light backgrounds

Gradient Rules

- Primary gradient: Light Blue → Vektrus Blue (135° angle) — for hero sections, covers, CTAs
- AI gradient: Vektrus Blue → AI Violet (max 10% of composition) — for AI feature highlights only
- Never use more than two colors in a single gradient
- Never apply gradients to body text or small UI elements

09. Typography System

Primary Typeface: Manrope

Manrope is a modern geometric sans-serif designed for clarity and warmth. It serves as the display and heading typeface across all Vektrus materials. Its slightly rounded terminals give it an approachable feel that aligns with the Guide archetype.

Source: Google Fonts (open source, SIL license)

Weights used: 600 (SemiBold) for headlines, 700 (Bold) for display/H1, 800 (ExtraBold) for hero text

Secondary Typeface: Inter

Inter is a highly legible sans-serif optimized for screens. It serves as the body text, captions, and UI typeface. Its large x-height and open apertures ensure readability at all sizes.

Source: Google Fonts / system-ui fallback

Weights used: 300 (Light) for captions, 400 (Regular) for body, 500 (Medium) for emphasis, 600 (SemiBold) for labels

Fallback Stack

font-family: 'Manrope', 'Inter', system-ui, -apple-system, 'Segoe UI', Roboto, sans-serif

10. Typography Hierarchy

Element	Typeface	Weight	Size	Usage
Display / Hero	Manrope	800	48–72px	Landing pages, hero sections
H1	Manrope	700	32–40px	Page titles, section headers
H2	Manrope	600	24–30px	Subsections, card titles
H3	Manrope	600	20–24px	Component headers
Body	Inter	400	16–18px	Paragraphs, descriptions
Body Bold	Inter	600	16–18px	Emphasis, key terms
Caption	Inter	400	12–14px	Metadata, timestamps
Label	Inter	500–600	12–14px	Form labels, tags, buttons
Overline	Manrope	600	11–12px	Section labels, ALL CAPS

Spacing Rules

- Line height: 1.5–1.6 for body text, 1.2–1.3 for headings
- Paragraph spacing: 16–24px after each paragraph
- Heading spacing: 32–48px before, 12–16px after
- Letter spacing: Normal for body, +0.5px for overlines, +1–2px for display text

11. UI Components

All UI components follow the Vektrus design system with consistent border radii, shadow depths, and interactive states.

Buttons

Type	Appearance	Usage
Primary	Vektrus Blue bg, white text, 8px radius	Main CTAs, form submissions, key actions
Secondary	Transparent bg, Vektrus Blue border + text	Secondary actions, cancel, back
Ghost	No border, Vektrus Blue text only	Tertiary actions, inline links
Danger	Alert Red bg, white text	Destructive actions, delete, disconnect

Cards

- Background: White or Mint White (#F4FCFE)
- Border radius: 12–16px
- Shadow: 0 2px 8px rgba(0,0,0,0.06)
- Padding: 20–24px
- Hover state: Shadow increases to 0 4px 16px rgba(73,183,227,0.12)

Input Fields

- Border: 1px solid #E0E0E0, radius 8px
- Focus state: Border changes to Vektrus Blue, subtle blue glow
- Error state: Border changes to Alert Red, error message below in red
- Height: 44–48px for standard inputs

12. AI State Logic & Animations

The Vektrus AI system has distinct visual states that communicate its current activity to users. These states use color, animation, and iconography to create an intuitive experience.

State	Visual Indicator	Color	Animation
Idle	Static node icon	Soft Gray	None
Thinking	Pulsing node network	AI Violet (10%)	Slow pulse, 2s cycle
Processing	Rotating connections	Vektrus Blue	Gentle rotation, 3s
Complete	Checkmark with glow	Success Green	Fade in, 0.3s ease
Error	Alert triangle	Alert Red	Shake, 0.5s
Learning	Growing node network	Light Blue → Violet	Expand nodes, 4s

Animation Principles

- Duration: 200–400ms for micro-interactions, 1–4s for state transitions
- Easing: ease-out for entrances, ease-in-out for state changes
- AI Violet glow: Maximum 10% opacity, used only during AI-active states
- Never use bouncing, spinning, or attention-grabbing animations—keep everything calm and professional

13. Imagery & Illustration Style

Photography Guidelines

- Bright, naturally-lit environments—no dark studio aesthetics
- Small teams, creators, and professionals in focused work scenes
- Diverse representation across age, gender, and ethnicity
- Modern, clean workspaces with technology visible but not dominant
- Color grading should lean slightly cool, matching the Light Blue palette
- Never use stock photos that feel staged, corporate, or generic

Illustration Style

- Minimal vector style with clean lines
- Network nodes, directional shapes, and data-flow metaphors
- Soft gradients from Light Blue to Vektrus Blue
- Flat design with subtle depth through gradient and shadow
- AI elements: Neural network patterns, node connections, learning visualizations

Graphic Element Patterns

- Subtle network grids as background texture (opacity 5–15%)
- Layered soft gradients for hero sections and feature backgrounds
- AI active glow: AI Violet radial gradient, max 10% opacity
- Directional arrows and growth indicators in Vektrus Blue
- Data visualization uses the full color palette with Vektrus Blue as primary data color

14. Iconography

The Vektrus icon system uses consistent line icons with rounded corners, designed for clarity at all sizes.

Icon Specifications

Property	Specification
Style	Line icons (not filled)
Corner radius	Rounded corners on all paths
Stroke width	2px consistent across all icons
Grid size	24×24px base grid with 2px padding
Colors	Vektrus Blue (#49B7E3) for primary, Soft Gray (#7A7A7A) for secondary
Touch target	Minimum 44×44px for interactive icons

Core Icon Set

- Navigation: Home, Chat, Planner, Insights, Media, Settings, Profile
- Actions: Add, Edit, Delete, Search, Filter, Sort, Export, Share
- Status: Success (checkmark), Error (triangle), Warning (circle), Info (i)
- AI: Brain/node network, Learning, Processing, Suggestion, Auto-generate
- Social: Instagram, LinkedIn, YouTube, X/Twitter, TikTok, Facebook

15. Social Media Design Rules

Profile & Cover Images

Platform	Dimensions	Design Treatment
Avatar (all)	Square, min 400px	V symbol on gradient (Light Blue → Vektrus Blue)
LinkedIn Cover	1584×396px	Gradient Light Blue → Vektrus Blue, tagline in white
Instagram Post	1080×1080px	Clean layout, bold headline, minimal elements on Mint White
YouTube Thumb	1280×720px	Data-driven visual, metric highlight, dark/blue gradient
X Banner	1500×500px	Minimalist: wordmark left, tagline right, white background

Content Post Rules

- Always include the Vektrus wordmark or V symbol as a subtle watermark
- Headlines in Manrope Bold/ExtraBold, body in Inter Regular
- Maximum 3 colors per post from the brand palette
- Data visualizations use Vektrus Blue as primary, Light Blue as secondary
- Text-heavy posts: White or Mint White background, Anthrazit text
- Never use AI Violet as a dominant color in social posts

16. Presentation Templates

Four core slide templates cover all presentation needs. All slides use Manrope for headings and Inter for body text.

Title Slide

- Background: Gradient Light Blue → Vektrus Blue
- Logo: Reversed white, bottom-left corner
- Title: Manrope 800, white, centered
- Subtitle: Inter 400, white at 85% opacity

Content Slide

- Background: White
- Header: Manrope 700, Vektrus Blue, left-aligned
- Body: Inter 400, Anthrazit
- Logo: Small wordmark, bottom-left, Light Blue color

Data Slide

- Charts: Vektrus Blue primary, Light Blue secondary, AI Violet for highlights
- Grid lines: Soft Gray at 30% opacity
- Labels: Inter 400, Soft Gray
- Key metrics: Manrope 800, Vektrus Blue

Closing Slide

- Background: Anthrazit (#111111)
- Headline: “Weniger Aufwand. Mehr Wirkung.” in Vektrus Blue
- CTA button: Outlined in Vektrus Blue
- URL: vektrus.com in Soft Gray below

17. Stationery & Email

Business Cards

Front: Light Blue (#B6EBF7) background. V symbol centered in white. Clean, no text.

Back: White background. Name in Manrope Bold, role in Inter Regular, contact in Soft Gray. Subtle V symbol watermark top-right at 15% opacity.

Size: Standard 85×55mm. Rounded corners optional (3mm radius).

Letterhead

- Header: Logo (combination mark) left-aligned, 18px height
- Body area: Generous white space, minimum 2cm margins
- Footer: Subtle Light Blue line (3px), company details in Soft Gray below
- Paper: Premium 120gsm uncoated white

Email Signature

- Left border: 3px Vektrus Blue accent line
- Name: Manrope Bold, Anthrazit
- Role: Inter Regular, Soft Gray
- Divider: 40px Light Blue line
- Contact: Inter 12px, Soft Gray, links in Vektrus Blue
- CTA: Small button “Jetzt kostenlos testen →” in Vektrus Blue
- V symbol: Small accent beside company name

18. Do’s and Don’ts

✔ DO	✘ DON’T
Use the logo with proper clear space	Stretch, skew, or rotate the logo
Use Vektrus Blue as the primary brand color	Use AI Violet as the primary brand color
Keep backgrounds light (White/Mint White)	Place logo on dark neon backgrounds
Use Manrope for headings, Inter for body	Mix more than 2 typefaces in one layout
Lead with data and specific metrics	Use hype language or unsubstantiated claims
Use Du-Ansprache in German copy	Switch between Du and Sie inconsistently
Keep AI Violet usage under 10%	Use gradients inside typography
Use line icons with 2px stroke	Use filled icons or inconsistent stroke widths
Maintain WCAG AA contrast ratios	Place light blue text on white backgrounds
Frame AI as a tool that empowers users	Position AI as replacing human judgment

19. Application Examples

The following examples demonstrate correct application of the Vektrus brand identity across key touchpoints. Refer to the accompanying HTML brand applications file for interactive visual mockups.

Website

- Navigation: White background, combination mark left, Vektrus Blue text links
- Hero section: Gradient background (Light Blue → Vektrus Blue), white headline text
- Feature cards: White or Mint White background, 16px radius, subtle shadow
- CTAs: Vektrus Blue buttons with white text, 8px radius
- Footer: Anthrazit background, Soft Gray text, Vektrus Blue links

Dashboard / Product UI

- Sidebar: White with Vektrus Blue active state indicators
- Content area: Mint White background
- Cards: White with 12px radius, elevation shadow
- Charts: Vektrus Blue primary, Light Blue secondary, AI Violet for AI-generated data
- Status indicators: Green (success), Red (error), Orange (pending)

Marketing Collateral

- Flyers: Clean layout, generous white space, maximum 3 colors per piece
- Banner ads: Gradient or Mint White background, bold headline, clear CTA
- Trade show materials: Combination mark prominent, gradient backdrop

20. Asset Library & File Structure

All brand assets are organized in a standardized folder structure for easy access and consistency across teams.

Directory Structure

Folder	Contents
/logo	All logo variations: combination, wordmark, symbol in SVG, PNG (1x, 2x, 3x), and EPS formats
/colors	Color palette swatches in ASE (Adobe), CLR (macOS), JSON, and CSS custom properties
/typography	Manrope and Inter font files (WOFF2, TTF), license files, and usage specimens
/ui-components	Figma component library, design tokens (JSON), and CSS component styles
/social-templates	Platform-specific templates for LinkedIn, Instagram, YouTube, X in Figma and PNG
/presentations	PowerPoint and Google Slides master templates with all four slide types
/icons	Complete icon set in SVG, icon font (WOFF2), and React component library
/illustrations	Brand illustrations, network patterns, gradient overlays, and AI state animations

File Naming Convention

- Logo files: vektrus-[type]-[variation]-[size].[ext]
- Example: vektrus-combination-primary-2x.png
- Social templates: vektrus-[platform]-[type]-[dimensions].[ext]
- Example: vektrus-linkedin-cover-1584x396.png
- Icons: vektrus-icon-[name]-[size].[ext]
- Example: vektrus-icon-insights-24.svg

“Weniger Aufwand. Mehr Wirkung.”

Vektrus Brand Guidelines • Version 2.0 • February 2026

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